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QP-008 Nonconforming Product Control

Standards and clause references are guidance only and do not claim certification or standard compliance. Applicable customer, contractual and legal requirements govern accepted work.

1. Purpose

Define the process for identifying, documenting, segregating, and dispositioning nonconforming product to prevent its unintended use or delivery.

2. Scope

Applies to all nonconforming material, in-process parts, and finished product discovered at any stage — receiving, in-process, final inspection, or after delivery (customer return).

3. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Shop Owner	Identify, document, segregate, and disposition all nonconforming product. Determine customer notification requirements. Authorize rework to the original requirements; obtain prior written customer approval for repair or use-as-is.

Role	Responsibility
External calibration provider, only when used	Report relevant out-of-tolerance conditions for the service supplied; no current laboratory engagement is implied

4. References

- QF-011 — Nonconforming Material Report
- QF-012 — Corrective Action Report (8D)
- QP-009 — Corrective Action
- QP-007 — Final Inspection and Product Release
- QP-023 — Customer Communication and Complaints
- NCR/CAR Log (06-registers/)
- AS9100 Rev D Clause 8.7

5. Definitions

- **Nonconformance:** Any condition where product, material, or process output does not meet specified requirements (drawing, specification, purchase order, or procedure).
- **Disposition:** The decision on what to do with nonconforming product (rework, repair, use-as-is, scrap, or return to supplier).
- **Quarantine Area:** The designated, physically marked area in the shop where nonconforming material is segregated pending disposition.
- **Concession:** Written authorization from the customer to accept product that does not conform to specified requirements (use-as-is or repair disposition).

6. Procedure

Identification

1. When a nonconformance is identified at any stage (receiving inspection, in-process, final inspection, or customer return), immediately stop work on the affected part(s).
2. Attach a red **REJECTED** hang tag under WI-008, showing the owner’s QC initials, inspection date and part number. Do not use marker dots or mix rejected parts with conforming product. A yellow **HOLD** tag is permitted for material awaiting verification or documentation; it does not authorize acceptance or shipment.
3. Move the nonconforming part(s) to the Quarantine Area.

Documentation

1. Initiate QF-011 Nonconforming Material Report (NCR). Assign the next sequential NCR number from the NCR/CAR Log.

2. Record the following on QF-011:
    - Job number, part number, drawing revision, quantity affected
    - Description of the nonconformance (what is wrong and what the requirement is)
    - Discovery point (receiving / in-process / final inspection / customer return)
    - Date discovered

Disposition

1. Evaluate the nonconformance and select one disposition:

    - **Rework:** Part can be brought into conformance by additional machining or processing within the original drawing requirements.
    - **Repair:** Part can be brought to usable condition but will not fully meet original drawing requirements. Requires customer approval before proceeding.
    - **Use-As-Is:** Part does not meet drawing requirements but is acceptable for the intended function. Requires customer approval (written) before release.
    - **Scrap:** Part cannot be reworked or repaired. Keep the red REJECTED hang tag attached, record the scrap disposition on QF-011 and render the part unusable before disposal. Do not use marker identification.
    - **Return to Supplier:** Nonconformance is attributable to incoming material or outside processing. Initiate supplier notification and return per QP-003 Purchasing and Supplier Management.

2. Record the selected disposition on QF-011. Sign and date as Disposition Authority.

Customer Notification

1. Notify the customer when ANY of the following apply:
    - Disposition is "Repair" or "Use-As-Is" (requires customer concession/waiver before proceeding)
    - Nonconforming product has already been shipped to the customer
    - The nonconformance involves a safety-critical characteristic
    - Customer purchase order requires notification of nonconformances
    - The nonconformance affects product provided to or received from an external provider (e.g., outsourced special processing) — notify the external provider of the nonconforming condition
2. Record customer notification details on QF-011 (date, method, person contacted, decision received).

Re-Inspection After Disposition

1. After rework or repair is complete, re-inspect the affected characteristic(s) and any characteristics that could have been affected by the rework/repair operation.

2. Record re-inspection results on the original QF-011 or on a new QF-005 In-Process Inspection Record referencing the NCR number.
3. Only release the part for further processing or shipment after re-inspection confirms conformance (or customer concession is documented for use-as-is/repair).

Closure

1. When disposition is complete and verified, sign and date the closure section of QF-011.
2. Enter the closure date in the NCR/CAR Log.

Corrective Action Escalation

1. Initiate a Corrective Action Request (QF-012) per QP-009 Corrective Action when ANY of the following apply:
   - The same or similar nonconformance has occurred more than once (repeat)
   - Nonconforming product escaped to the customer
   - The nonconformance involves a safety-critical characteristic
   - The nonconformance results in significant scrap cost or delivery impact
2. Record the related CAR number on QF-011.

7. Records Generated

Form No.	Title	When Completed
QF-011	Nonconforming Material Report	When any nonconformance is identified
QF-012	Corrective Action Request	When escalation criteria in Step 15 are met

8. Revision History

Rev	Date	Description	Approved By
A	2026-08-06	Initial release	Shop Owner

Revision B Approval

Approved 2026-11-05 by Jacob Honick, Owner. Standardize control metadata and annual review, remove fixed page counts and align applicable references and wording.